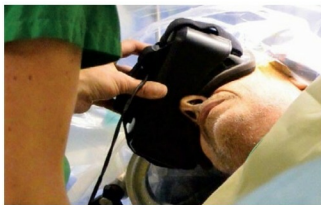


of a capacitor. When an electric field is applied, cells' polarisation can be aligned in two ways depending on the direction of the field. This represents the two possible values of a bit of information that the chip stores.

VR headset maps brain during surgery

Virtual reality (VR) is becoming quite useful when it comes to the medical field. At Angers University Hospital, France, physicians used a VR headset to map a patient's brain during surgery to remove a tumour. The patient was conscious during the procedure in which doctors used a virtual environment to map zones of the brain. Until now, said mapping and monitoring neural connections in certain areas were not easily achieved in the operating room.



The patient was played a piece of VR software that activated certain parts of the brain that would normally be very difficult to test (Image courtesy: www.t3.com)

Neurosurgeon Philippe Menei explained, "By totally controlling what the patient sees and hears, we can put him in situations that allow us to do tests on certain connections that were not possible before."

Neural chip performs AI tasks

Researchers from Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), USA, have developed a new energy-efficient neural chip that can run powerful artificial intelligence (AI) algorithms locally, without depending on the Internet for heavy data processing. The chip is called Eyeriss and is ten times as efficient as a mobile GPU, and can possibly increase the task-handling capability of mobile devices.

A neural network is a vast virtual network of information processors, modelled to emulate the processing technique of the human brain. It is used to execute powerful computational processes and to run algorithms that are too heavy for a single low-power device to handle.

Eyeriss has 168 cores, and each of these has its own memory unlike a single, shared memory bank found in

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